

tion, which can be done even by HTML-illiterate users. This is a strong reason to switch to the Beta version.

8.3.4.9 Making Money from your blog

AdSense is a programme promoted by Google that involves putting text ads onto your site and making money every time a visitor to the blog clicks on the ad. If you intend to convert your blog into a money-making operation, Blogger can help you. You can find the option to enable AdSense under the Template Tab. Before you can start making money, you need to sign up for the AdSense programme. Then you can choose the size and colour of the ad box you're willing to show on your blog.

The content in the ad box comes from the servers at Google. Details of the AdSense programme are covered thoroughly in another chapter. But briefly, the ads that will appear in the box will be dictated by the content on your page. Every time a visitor to your blog is motivated to click on the ad, you earn. The AdSense programme administrators will review your blog to see whether it is worthy of inclusion, and only then can you hear the ring as the pennies add up.

8.4 The Beta

Google now offers an upgraded beta version of the Blogger service, albeit with two important caveats—you need a Gmail account, and the switch-over is permanent. So do not use your existing account to “test” the beta, since you will not be able to switch back to the old Blogger if the new one is not to your liking. It is better to create a new identity and then test the Beta.

8.4.1 Additional Features

At first glance, not much distinguishes the Beta from the original Blogger interface. The Settings tab and all its contents are similar.